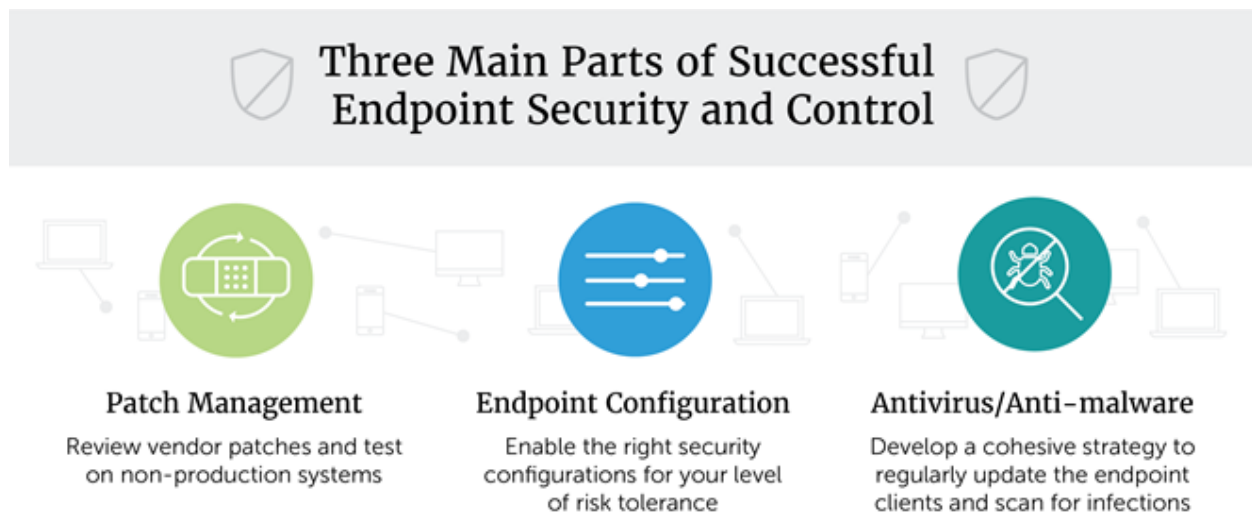


Endpoint Patching Strategy:

There are many layers in security, such as physical, network, data, access and identity management, and many more. When it comes to securing your endpoints, you really have three main parts to worry about: patch management, endpoint configuration & antivirus/anti-malware. Patch Management has its own relevance in cyber security; it addresses those vulnerabilities in software and systems which cyber criminals would make use of to gain entry into systems and networks and then steal sensitive personal data or lock users out and demand ransom. Yes, effective patch management is key to cyber security.

Patching is usually the first line of defense in endpoint security because it addresses defects in the operating system or installed software. Whenever a patch is applied, it's important to test and verify it. This is really important since a flawed patch could pose a serious security threat and could cause issues with the system and the network as a whole.



In May 2017, a worldwide cyberattack, known as WannaCry, exploited a vulnerability in Microsoft's SMB protocol. It wreaked havoc across the world, infecting more than 200,000 systems in 150 countries. Microsoft had known about the vulnerability and released a patch several months before. However, the main reason so many systems were affected was because those system owners never applied the patch. This event showed that ignoring it can have disastrous consequences.